



A BACKYARD ADVENTURE STORYBOOK

The Unicorn Parade

Everyone makes a mount. One is real.



On a bright Saturday morning, Bandit flung open the back door holding a cardboard scroll. "By royal decree," he announced, "UNICORN PARADE DAY is officially ON!"



Bluey gasped with joy. Bingo clapped her paws. Chilli smiled and read the rules aloud: ride anything you like, use your imagination, and no zooming past the parade leader.



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The doorbell rang. Lia arrived with a bag of ribbons and a shiny mop handle. "Parade supplies!" she said. "My mum helped me pick the best colours."



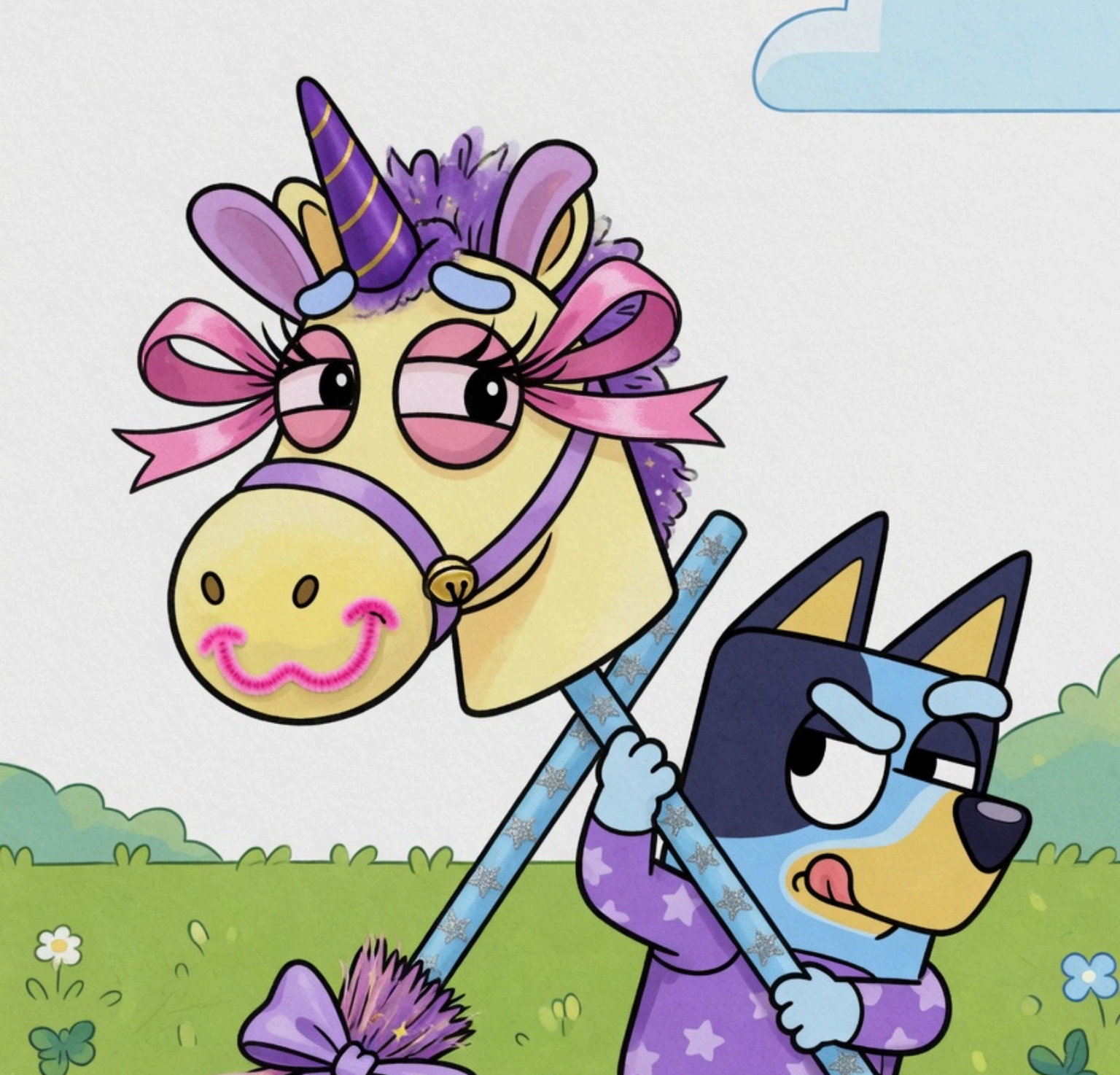
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Bingo got to work on her tricycle, tying pink and yellow streamers to every handle. They fluttered in the breeze like tiny flags. "Meet Starwheel," she said proudly.

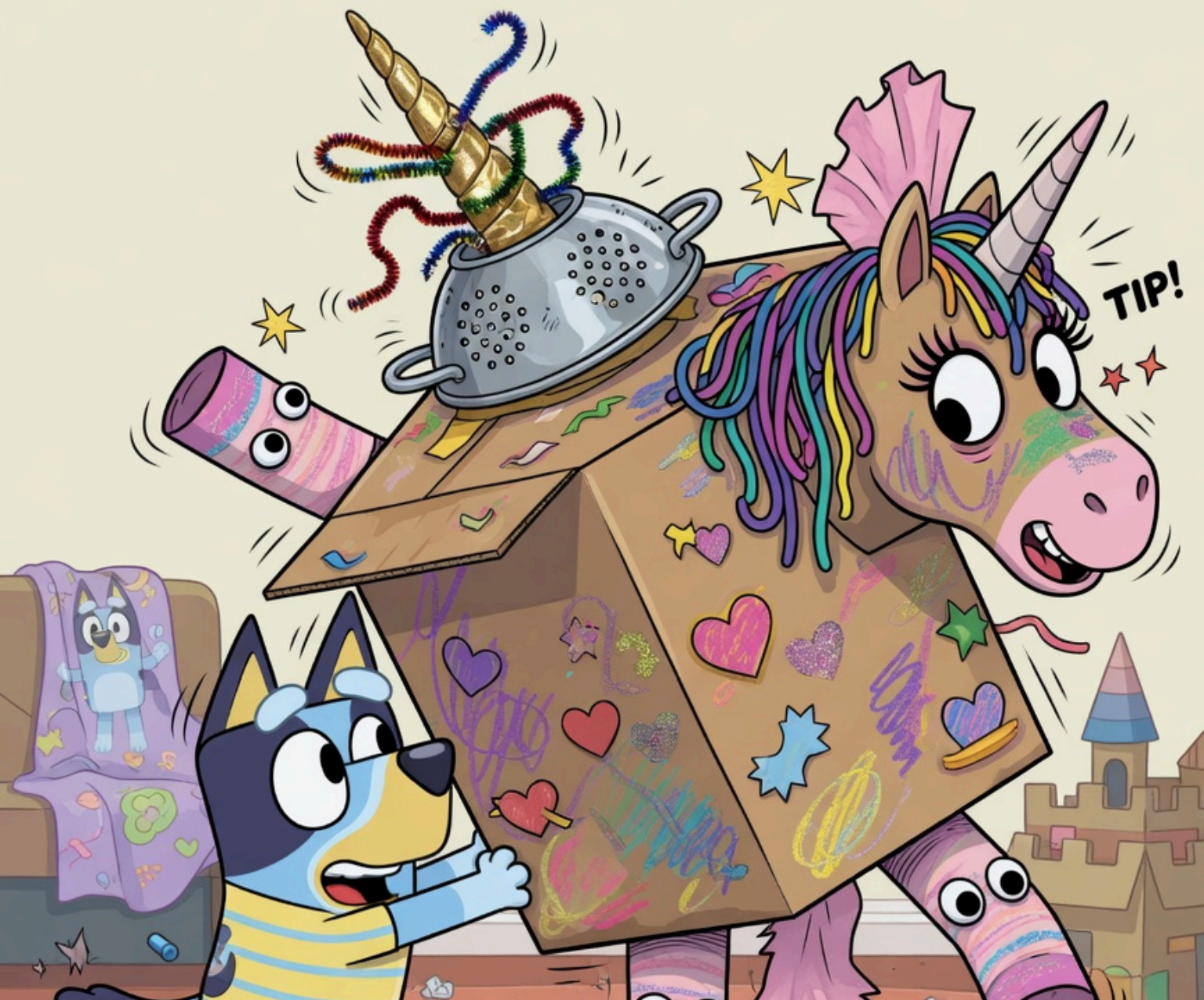


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Muffin painted silver stars on the wheelbarrow and taped a bent pool noodle to the front as a magnificent horn. "Presenting: Comet Crusher!" she shouted.



Socks dragged a broom across the grass. "This is Thunder Hooves the Brave," she told everyone very seriously. The broom had two ribbon eyes and a pipe-cleaner smile.



Bluey built the LOUDEST unicorn of all: stacked cardboard boxes for a body, a colander horn, and wobbly paper-towel-roll legs. It tipped left. It tipped right. Bluey loved it anyway.



Chilli handed out tape and safety pins, fixing a wobble here and a streamer there. "Parade yes," she laughed. "Manageable chaos, absolutely."



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Lia wrapped purple and pink ribbon around the mop handle. She drew a gentle eye on paper and taped it on. "This is Ribbonwish," she whispered. "Built with kindness."



Bandit became Parade Marshal, wearing a saucepan lid as a shield and tapping a wooden spoon baton. "Unicorns to the starting line, please!" he called.



They lined up along the back fence. Chilli counted softly. "One unicorn, two unicorns, three unicorns..." The yard looked like a rainbow had exploded in the best possible way.



TOOT went the kettle whistle! The parade began. Bingo pedalled Starwheel. Muffin pushed Comet Crusher. Bluey steadied her box unicorn. Socks rode Thunder Hooves with great dignity.



Around the clothesline pole they marched, streamers flying, wheels squeaking, broom bristles swishing. Even the magpie on the fence tilted its head, impressed.



Socks wobbled on Thunder Hooves. Bingo steadies her with a gentle paw. "Parade buddies stick together," she said. Socks nodded and held on tighter.



Muffin tried to sprint ahead. "I'm winning the parade!" Bandit tapped his baton. "Parade pace, not race, Your Sparkliness." Muffin slowed down and stuck out her tongue.



Lia walked at the back, guiding Ribbonwish with both hands. A tiny shimmer danced above the ribbons — like a sunbeam with a secret.



Then Ribbonwish seemed to lift — just one inch off the grass. Lia's eyes went wide. The shimmer grew brighter. Something was answering her kindness.



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Stardust stepped out of the light — a real unicorn, white as morning, mane purple and pink, horn gold and glowing. She walked beside Ribbonwish as if they had always been a pair.



Everyone fell quiet. No tooting. No wobbling. They marched one slow circle together — handmade and magical, side by side — while the whole backyard held its breath.



The End

At the gum tree, Stardust bowed low. Then she slipped behind the trunk and was gone. Chilli found a single pink ribbon on the grass. Lia looked down — one tiny glitter hoofprint on her shoe.

THE END

Design your own parade unicorn. What would you ride? Draw it and march once around your room.